

PRINCIPLES

1. Always use the "Rule of the Square" to determine if your pawn can promote before the enemy king can catch it.
2. Identify and control key squares to enhance your pawn's promotion chances.
3. Bring your king closer to the pawn to support its advance.
4. Use opposition to restrict the movement of the enemy king.
5. Avoid pushing your pawn too early; ensure your king is in a favorable position first.
6. Understand how to promote doubled pawns effectively against a king.
7. In king and pawn versus king endgames, always aim to keep your king in front of the pawn.
8. Calculate potential pawn promotions carefully before making moves.
9. Use shouldering techniques to block the opposing king's path.
10. Familiarize yourself with basic winning and drawing techniques in pawn endgames.

SITUATION

In this lesson, we explore a King and Pawn vs. King ending where the white pawn is on a4 and the black king is on h8. The objective is to determine if the pawn can promote without the assistance of the king. The position requires calculating the race between the pawn and the enemy king, which can be simplified using the 'rule of the square.' This rule helps visualize whether the pawn can promote before being captured by the opposing king.

FEN: 8/5k2/8/4P3/4K3/8/8/8 w - - 0 1

GOAL

White aims to promote the pawn while preventing the black king from blocking its path. Black's goal

is to reach the pawn and capture it before it promotes.

STRATEGY

Use the 'rule of the square' to determine if the pawn can promote before the black king can catch it. If the black king cannot reach the square, the pawn can promote. This requires careful calculation and visualization of the board.

MOVES

First, move the king to f5 to block the black king's direct path. If they respond with Kf8, advance to e6 controlling key squares. The most accurate move order would be: 1. Kf5 Kf8 2. Ke6 Ke8 3. e6 Kd8 4. Kf7

HOW IT LINKS TO THE RULES

This lesson demonstrates the Rule of the Square, which helps determine if the pawn can promote before being captured. It also emphasizes the importance of controlling key squares and the concept of opposition.